



Microsoft teaching kids

Microsoft is using Minecraft to teach basics of coding to kids on code.org.
<http://dgit.in/CodeMinecft>

Loseriously?

Reports show that teens cannot differentiate between Google search result and an ad. <http://dgit.in/GSearchAD>

LETTER OF THE MONTH

✉ I'm one of your avid readers from Nepal. If you look at it historically then I'm an Indian but I was born in Nepal, where I live presently. But, then again, I've studied six years in India. So I'm not so sure what my nationality is. But since I have a legal Nepalese citizenship, it's better to say I'm Nepali. Anyway, I was introduced to Digit in India. I was in Class 6 when I bought my first Digit. We were taken to a book fair in Patna and I was delighted to buy the magazine. I wasn't much of a reader back then, and purchased the mag only for the CDs which had games and videos inside them. But, now, seven years later, I buy Digit primarily for reading. Sometimes, now, I don't even bother to insert the CD into my laptop unless I see some interesting software or video included. So, technically, I've been reading Digit since four years.

Digit is worth buying and I like almost everything about it. The information you all provide is really handy. I just got the November issue today thanks to the strike in the country. Normally, I get my issue within some five days after you publish it (which is still very late for avid Digit readers like me). Please expand your presence here and give us Nepali readers a chance to subscribe to your magazine, so that even we can avail of some offers and get our hands on some goodies.



Okay, now let's talk about Team Digit. I only read Robert's editorial. I don't know why but his articles are very attractive to read. I'm sorry to say, Sid and Jayesh, I don't read your editorials more often. Forgive me for that. The best parts of the magazine are the snippets on the top of the page and the Sci Tech section. I love the Bazaar section too, as I like reading reviews of the latest gadgets.

Whose idea was it to bring out the dmystify booklet? Well, whoever came up with the idea, thank you very much. It's really worth reading.

I wish you'd include at least five new or unique software in the CD. Usually, you only give us updates to the last software you included. We can update them ourselves. Also, could you include the apks of the Android games that you review? Actually, internet here in Nepal is really costly. And not everyone has a fiber or wireless connection at home. It would be very generous of you if you could provide that. It wouldn't take much space, would it?

Finally, you guys are amazing. Keep up this fascinating work. Nikhil Pradhan, aren't you from Nepal? I think I read your article in the May issue. I just wanted to tell you that you're making Nepal proud. At least we have one Nepali working at Digit. I'll write to you all soon. Next time, I'll emphasise more on the magazine than myself and my country.

Lots of love from Nepal.
 Yours truly,

– Sunny Sarraf

✉ Hi Sunny,

It was in fact refreshing to hear your story rather than just the usual.

At the same time we can never get tired of hearing about ourselves, so we're looking forward to your next letter too :-)

Yes, the DVD has gotten a little boring of late, but we're trying to improve it. Check out the upcoming special issue DVDs (yes, two this time as well) for some interesting software. The trouble with distributing apks is that there's always the risk of a security issue. And there are also some legal concerns. It was great to hear from you and do keep writing in (even if you don't read my or Jayesh's column).

P.S. Nikhil has unfortunately left Digit, but I'll be sure to forward your mail to him.

– Siddharth

Thanks for reading my letter and replying so soon. You won't believe but after I sent you the letter, I got excited on each mail I received and eventually I got it. Yeah, I will sure be checking your DVDs. I am glad there are two this time. Yeah I understand about the security issue for distribution of apks. I should have thought that before.

And yes, I will surely read yours and Jayesh's column. I am sorry to hear about Nikhil. I would be gratified if Nikhil read this mail. Once again thanks. And I will write a letter soon. Happy Digitizing.

– Sunny

jargon which you couldn't understand before suddenly starts to make sense? If you're interested in ethical hacking be sure to check out the FastTrack on the same topic in this month's DVDs. As for SKOAR! being bigger, we couldn't agree with you more!

– Siddharth

✉ 'dmystify' - "The small book of big knowledge" is worth gold. I must say each and every issue of this book is

worth reading. I often use it as a reference book to update my scientific knowledge. The books are indeed step-by-step guides towards building up scientific knowledge. Won't it be good if dmystify started covering topics that are necessary to understanding basic computer science and technology? For example, a bi-annual series such as "Electricity & Electronics - I, II, III..etc" every year. Understanding electricity and electronics would be easy if introduced in a step-by-

step manner by explaining computer and technology jargon.

– Dominic M Sangma

✉ Internally we often joke about how Digit is the technology main course and dmystify is the science side-dish. For now we'd like to keep dmystify only to limited to core science but perhaps we could start another book series like we did with Encyclopedia Technica specifically pertaining to the topics you mentioned.